ગુજરાતી શિક્ષણ સંઘ

Consortium of Gujarati Schools

https://www.gujaratischools.org/

Writing Course

Morning Session 1

Assessment for Learning (AfL)

&

Afternoon Workshop Session

Level Descriptions for Gujarati Writing

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Assessment

What types of assessment?

1. Formative Assessment:

   To inform your teaching, identify areas for improvement and track learner's progress.

2. Summative assessment:

   To evaluate total learning at the end of a unit, course or programme. End of Year exam; GCSE etc.

3. Diagnostic Assessment:

   To identify the learner's strengths and weaknesses at the start of a course of study. Helps with appropriate class allocation in school.

Assessment for Learning

Assessment for Learning (AfL) is an educational approach that focuses on using assessment as a tool to improve student learning and inform instruction. It is a **formative assessment**.

Key principles of Assessment for Learning:

1. Ongoing and informal: AfL involves regular, informal assessments to monitor student's progress.
2. Feedback-Rich: AfL emphasizes constructive feedback that guides the student's learning. Teachers can adjust how and what they teach based on
3. Student-centred: AfL focuses on student's learning and involves the student in the assessment process.

What are the **benefits** of AfL?

- Improved relationship between teachers and students.
- Improved attainment and achievement.
- Improved confidence, resilience, and self-esteem amongst students.
- Improved classroom culture and teaching environment
- Improved sense of motivation. Many teachers also involve children in measuring their own learning by using self-assessment (can do statements) and target setting.
- Improved awareness of own thoughts. Students are able to think out loud. They say out loud what they are thinking, step by step, while they are completing a written task. This helps them become more effective, independent learners.

Let us try to include AfL in our own teaching of the Gujarati Language. AfL is used for all 4 aspects of language acquisition: Speaking, Listening, Reading and writing. Here we focus on Writing skills.

Use of AfL for Gujarati - Writing

AfL in Writing allows us to **evaluate** and **give feedback** to our students on their written work. Also, to understand the strengths & weaknesses. This will show us the next steps in order to progress their writing skills.

What assessment tool? We can use '**Level descriptions for Gujarati writing Assessment'**.

Steps to Assess Writing using AfL Level Descriptions

1. Familiarise yourself with Level Descriptions: Understand the AfL level descriptions which outline the expected standards for different levels.
2. Determine the key criteria to assess, such as:
    - Formation & writing the script – basic letters/ words – accuracy in particular different linguistic nuances between writing Gujarati and English (**often stems from oracy!)**
    - Content and ideas
    - Organisation and structure
    - Language use (vocabulary, grammar, sentence structure)
    - Spelling and punctuation
    - Translation elements
3. Assess student Writing: Evaluate student writing sample against the level descriptions, considering the key criteria.
4. Match to Level descriptions: Match the student's writing to the corresponding level description, identifying strengths and areas for improvement.
5. Provide Feedback: provide **constructive feedback** to students, highlighting areas of strength and suggesting improvements.

Using Level Descriptions to plan/inform teaching

1. Identify gaps: Identify gaps in student's understanding and adjust teaching accordingly.
2. Tailor the teaching: Tailor your instruction to meet the needs of individual students, focusing on what requires improvement.
3. Monitor progress: Regularly monitor student progress, adjusting instruction and feedback as needed.

Assessment for Learning

Level Descriptions for Gujarati Writing

Level 1

Learners write or copy words or symbols correctly. They label items and select appropriate words to complete sentences. Their writing shows letters hanging from the line.

Level 2

Learners write one or two short sentences, following a model, and fill in the words on a simple form. They write familiar short phrases correctly. When they write familiar words from memory, their spelling may be approximate.

Level 3

Learners write a few short sentences, with support, using expressions that they may have already learnt. They express personal responses. They write short phrases from memory and their spelling is readily understandable. Their word order follows Subject-Object-Verb pattern.

Level 4

Learners write short texts on familiar topics, adapting language that they have already learnt. They mostly make use of memorised language. They begin to use their knowledge of grammar to adapt and substitute individual words and set phrases, using post positions correctly. They begin to use dictionaries or glossaries to check words they have learnt.

Level 5

Learners write short texts on a range of familiar topics, using simple sentences. They refer to recent experiences or future plans, as well as to everyday activities. They use an Increasing range of vocabulary. Although there may be some mistakes, the meaning can be understood with little or no difficulty. They use dictionaries or glossaries to check words they have learnt and to look up unknown words.

Level 6

Learners write texts giving and seeking information and opinions. They use descriptive language and a variety of structures. They apply grammar in new contexts. Risks are taken in using language not practised in class. Although there may be a few mistakes, the meaning is usually clear.

Level 7

Learners write articles and stories of varying lengths, conveying opinions and points of view. They write about real and imaginary subjects and use appropriate language in different situations. They link sentences and paragraphs, structure ideas and adapt previously learnt language for their own purposes. They edit and redraft their work, using reference sources to improve their accuracy, precision and expression.

Level 8

Learners produce formal and informal texts in an appropriate style on familiar topics. They express and justify ideas, opinions or personal points of view and seek the view of others. They develop the content of what they have read, seen or heard. Their spelling and grammar are generally accurate. They use reference materials to extend their range of language and improve their accuracy.

Exceptional performance

Learners communicate ideas accurately and in an appropriate style over a range of topics, both factual and imaginative. They write coherently and accurately. Their spelling may not always be completely accurate but the meaning will be clear. Writing shows an awareness of how to address people formally and informally as appropriate.

Learners produce translations which have factual accuracy, cultural nuances and clarity. They demonstrate a clear understanding of the grammar and syntax in the original text as well as that of the target language.